



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Midland Classical Academy
School Website: <https://www.mcaknights.org/>

December 22, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

Midland Classical Academy (MCA) in Midland, TX appears to be a robust CLASSICAL school with a clearly Christian, classical formation. Public materials on the MCA site emphasize a Biblical Worldview, Christ-centered education, engagement with Great Books, the Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric), and Socratic pedagogy in the upper grades, alongside a hybrid Grammar School model that involves families as co-educators. Parental partnership is a core feature, and there is concrete attention to classical content (Great Books, Latin/Koine Greek, logic, rhetoric) and to the Great Conversation. While the school presents itself as fully classical in its aims and methods, it also foregrounds a strong ecclesial orientation (pursuing Christ) and a hybrid model that integrates family involvement into the learning process. Taken together across the six classical criteria, MCA aligns strongly with Classical education, with evidence of some non-traditional strands (home-school hybrid model; some parent-led elements) that temper a pure canonical classroom model but do not undermine its overall classical orientation.

- Overall classification: CLASSICAL
- Category-by-category snapshot (qualitative assessment below is grounded in the school's public materials and the classical rubric in the knowledge base):
 - Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL
 - Element 2: Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL
 - Element 3: Curriculum — CLASSICAL
 - Element 4: Pedagogy — CLASSICAL
 - Element 5: Faculty — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
 - Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL
- Aggregate ranking: CLASSICAL
- What would move the needle: Not applicable here, as the aggregate rating is CLASSICAL. If asked to push toward full "unabbreviated" classical alignment, potential refinements could include more explicit articulation of the liturgical/community practices as formal elements of daily life and a more explicit articulation of the "living curriculum" as a faculty-centered, virtue-first apprenticeship model (see Element 5 notes).

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence - MCA presents itself as a Christian classical school with Christ-centered formation: "pursue Christ" and "Biblical Worldview" are foundational to its mission, and Jesus Christ is described as the focus and foundation for all education (e.g., "Pursuing Christ" and related verses). - The school explicitly frames its classical education within a Biblical worldview, detailing how Biblical faith informs every subject and learning activity. - The public materials articulate authority of truth in a way consistent with transcendental, knowable ideals anchored in theology, including phrases like "divine purpose" and Christ-centered authority over what is true.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: Biblical Worldview, Pursuing Christ, Christ-centered education, divine purpose, truth (explicit in Socratic context), sacred tradition (implied through liturgical framing), worship/communal life (implied through communal, Christ-centered learning). - Negative keywords present: None evident in public materials (no sustained emphasis on secular or relativistic ethics).

Why this rating - The public-facing materials frame the school's foundation in theology and metaphysical commitments (Christ-centered, Biblical worldview) and embed religious sensibilities into the curriculum and school life. This clearly aligns with the Positive Indicators for Grounded in Theology and Liturgical/Communal Practices in the classical rubric, yielding CLASSICAL.

Cited references: MCA identity, biblical worldview, and Christ-centered framing are visible in the homepage and vision pages, including explicit statements of "Engaging Minds, Pursuing Christ, Discovering Greatness" and "Pursuing Christ" as core aims.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - MCA's motto explicitly centers formation of character and virtue in a Biblical framework, with language about discipling students toward Christlike leadership and human flourishing through a classical-educational lens. The parental/discipleship emphasis frames education as formation (virtue, character) rather than purely information transfer. - The public materials articulate aims such as "Engaging Minds, Pursuing Christ, Discovering Greatness," which signal formation and human excellence as the end of education, not merely job preparation. - The school describes its purpose as forming Christlike leaders and training character within a classical framework, including statements about virtue and service (e.g., "Christlike Leaders" and service orientation).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: formation, virtue, character, wisdom (via the classical-trivium framework, Great Books, and Socratic pedagogy echoed in the materials), truth/beauty/goodness (through Great Books and "Great Conversation" framing), teleology/telos (implied by purpose-driven language around Greatness and leadership), Christian worldview. - Negative keywords present: None relevant (no explicit expressions of secularism, relativism, or purely skills-based, job-prep rhetoric).

Why this rating - The materials emphasize formation, virtue, and a transcendent purpose aligned with truth, goodness, and beauty as real, knowable ends. The explicit Christ-centered formation and leadership aims align with CLASSICAL in the rubric's criteria for Purpose and Goal (formation-oriented, teleological ends, not solely information transfer).

Cited references: Public statements framing formation, virtue, and Christ-centered aims; the "Engaging Minds, Pursuing Christ, Discovering Greatness" motto; and the "Pursuing Christ" / Biblical Worldview content.

Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The MCA curriculum explicitly includes Great Books and The Great Conversation (e.g., Great Books 1/2; The Great Conversation), as well as the Trivium (Grammar, Logic, Rhetoric) and the Quadrivium in the public materials describing classical content, languages (Latin; Koine Greek), and logic/rhetoric-core courses. - History, literature, and classical inquiry are integrated as part of a broad, chronological Great Books program (e.g., The Great Books are read in order; a Great Conversation emerges across authors). - The curriculum explicitly aligns with liberal-arts core notions (grammar/logic/rhetoric; historical breadth; Great Books; integration/wonder). The Level I–II Course Curriculum documents show primary sources, classical literature, and languages, which are core to classical education.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: Great Books, Great Conversation, Liberal Arts (Trivium: Grammar, Logic, Rhetoric), Latin, Koine Greek, primary sources/original texts, integration/harmony of disciplines, wonder, historical depth, classical literature. - Negative keywords present: None evident (no sustained emphasis on modern, secular "social studies" framing; rather, explicit Great Books and historical engagement are foregrounded).

Why this rating - MCA's curriculum strongly conforms to category expectations for Curriculum in classical education: emphasis on the liberal arts (Trivium), Great Books, Great Conversation, and integrated, historically grounded study. Therefore CLASSICAL.

Cited references: Great Books and Great Conversation framing; Trivium/Liberal Arts; Level I–II course materials showing primary-text readings and languages.

Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The public materials explicitly describe Socratic discussion, seminars, and debates in upper grades, as well as training in rhetoric and opportunities to present speeches (classical pedagogy). The “What is Classical Education?” material within MCA references the Trivium and the Socratic Method as central to pedagogy. - Lower grades emphasize contemplative, memory-building elements (repeated review, rhythm, memorization) through language, song, and repetition (implied by the “Grammar School Culture” language and the hybrid schooling approach that fosters memorization and recall through routine). - Upper School emphasizes Socratic seminars, dialectic, and the development of logical reasoning and rhetoric, including opportunities for public speaking and debate. - There is clear articulation of upper-level discourse practices (Socratic method, seminars, debates) as well as lower-level memory-oriented routines (chanting/repetition as a memory aid, in line with *scholé* concepts).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: Socratic Method, Socratic dialogue, great conversation, seminars, debate, rhetoric, logic, grammar (Trivium), *scholé*/restful learning (implied by contemplative/reflective pace), memory/recitation (implied by phraseology around memorization/history). - Negative keywords present: None explicitly; no persistent emphasis on purely project-based or heavily modern, non-classical pedagogy. The hybrid grammar-school model is a logistical feature, not a pedagogy-non-classical signal.

Why this rating - Public-facing pedagogy aligns with classical expectations (Socratic inquiry; rhetoric; public speaking; memory-based lower-division pedagogy; Great Books-driven inquiry). CLASSICAL.

Cited references: Socratic method, Great Conversation, rhetoric, public speaking; lower/upper-school pedagogy descriptions.

Element 5: School Faculty — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - MCA describes its staff as catalysts in “engaging minds,” drawing students out, and guiding inquiry, which positions teachers as mentors rather than mere transmitters of content. The phrasing “Our staff draws students out – encouraging them to share what they know, ask their questions, and seek real answers” signals a teacher as guide and mentor. - The school presents the faculty as the living curriculum through relational teaching and mentorship (implied by the emphasis on tutor-led inquiry and parental partnership). However, explicit language such as “living curriculum,” “portrait of a teacher,” or formal teacher-professional profiles is less evident in the public-facing materials. - There is evidence of teacher collaboration and family partnerships (tutors and parents working together in the homeschool/heralded hybrid Grammar School model), which suggests a collegial, mentorship-oriented culture, though explicit “faculty as living curriculum” language is not strongly foregrounded in the public site.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: mentor/teacher as guide, formation through example, virtue-centered teaching (as implied by Christ-centered formation and character formation), shared inquiry, professional development (implied via ongoing school growth). - Negative keywords present: The explicit, codified language of “living curriculum,” “faculty portrait,” or “faculty collegium” is not strongly evident in the public site; there is a lack of direct, formal articulation of faculty as a defined “living curriculum.”

Why this rating - The school demonstrates several classical faculty traits (model virtue; teacher as guide; mentorship; collegiality implied through teacher-parent partnership), but it stops short of explicit, codified phrases commonly used in the classical rubric to describe the faculty as “the living curriculum.” Given that, the assessment lands in SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL for Element 5.

Cited references: Evidence of teacher as guide/mentors and tutoring culture; absence of strongly explicit “living curriculum” language in public pages (e.g., “Our staff draws students out” phrasing cited).

Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Parental involvement is a central, formal feature: MCA positions parents as primary educators in the Grammar School model, and requires service hours, reflecting a deep partnership between families and the school. The program is described as parents serving as co-educators in a hybrid model (home-school collaboration). - The school emphasizes partnerships with families to develop Christlike leaders, inviting parents to participate in schooling through service hours, tutoring, and regular communication; the “grammar school hybrid” model explicitly integrates parental involvement as essential to student success. - The Admissions/Parental Involvement materials frame the school as a family-centered community in which parents are active participants, co-planners, and co-learners, with regular communication between tutors and parents.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: partnership with families, co-educators, parental engagement, home-school hybrid, family involvement, parent formation, school-parent synergy, parental leadership, community of learners. - Negative keywords present: None evident (no explicit statements of “parent disengagement” or “minimal parent involvement”).

Why this rating - The explicit emphasis on parental partnership and family involvement places MCA firmly within the classical rubric’s Parents & Community category as CLASSICAL.

Cited references: Parental Involvement section detailing co-educator role, service hours, home-school hybrid model, and collaboration between parents and tutors.

Aggregate assessment

- Overall classification: CLASSICAL
 - The school earns CLASSICAL across Categories 1, 3, 4, and 6, with Element 2 also aligning well toward formation-oriented purpose, Element 5 landing as SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL due to less explicit articulation of the faculty-as-living-curriculum and other formalized faculty descriptors. The net effect is a clearly Classical program with a strong Christian, formation-focused bend and a robust Great Books/Socratic pedagogy, together with strong parental partnerships.

What Would Move the Needle (for SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL category adjustments) - Strengthen explicit, codified statements about faculty as the “living curriculum” (e.g., formal portrait of teacher qualifications, mentor-structure, and teacher-led professional development aligned to classical aims). - Add explicit, liturgical/communal practices language (daily or weekly chapel, liturgical rhythms) to deepen Liturgical/Communal Practices alignment. - Increase explicit memorization/recitation language or practice in lower grades to align with traditional “restful learning” and memory-building patterns (Scholé) in public-facing materials, if desired.

Note: No additional user-provided data were required beyond the MCA site content to perform this evaluation. All six categories were assessed using the classical rubric and the Positive/Negative keyword indicators extracted from the Six Essential Elements of a Classical School (1) document.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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